



A screen screaming blue, a partition giving you the blues. Resolve them, and with your work, get glued!

Recover registry in XP

Q. One fine day, as I started up my computer, I got a message that said, "Windows XP could not start because the following file is missing or corrupt: `!WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\CONFIG\SYSTEM`". What do I do?

Badri Narayan

A To start up your machine without re-installing, you need to execute some commands at the recovery console. To get to the recovery console, boot with the help of a bootable Windows XP CD, and press [R] when prompted to enter the recovery console. Select your Windows folder, and enter the administrator password.

Once at the console prompt, the first thing to do is back up the existing file; you do so by executing the following commands at the prompt:

md tmp

```
copy c:\windows\system32\config\system
c:\windows\tmp\system.bak
```

Now you need to replace these files with the proper, non-corrupt files, which are in the repair folder in the Windows directory:

```
copy c:\windows\repair\system c:\win-
dows\system32\config\system
```

Now you can boot into Windows XP, but, as this file was backed up when Windows was originally installed, any changes and settings after that are lost.

If System Restore is enabled on your system, you can get back to the last restore point.

To do this, boot into Safe Mode with administrator privileges, go to the drive where Windows XP is installed, and look for the 'System Volume Information' folder. Look for a snapshot folder—for example, `C:\System Volume Information\restore{C0B08955-BE89-4849-ABC0-715FCDE6CE4A}\RP3`. Copy the `_REGISTRY_MACHINE_SYSTEM` file to the 'tmp' folder by typing in '`copy _REGISTRY_MACHINE_SYSTEM c:\windows\tmp\_REGISTRY_MACHINE_SYSTEM`'.

Go to the recovery console again, using the Windows XP boot disk, and copy this file over the existing one by typing '`copy c:\windows\tmp\_registry_machine_system c:\windows\system32\config\system`'.

Restart Windows normally, start System Restore and restore your machine to any point you wish.

Project home studio

Q. I want to set up my own home studio. Can you tell me the best PC configuration to do so?

Rajieve Tanck

A For a home studio PC, we suggest you buy a Pentium 3.2c, an Intel 875PBZ motherboard, 512 MB or more of 400 MHz DDR RAM, a 7,200-rpm Samsung

hard drive—80 GB or more, a 9600 Pro graphics card, an Audigy2 sound card, a 19-inch monitor, a floppy disk drive, a keyboard, an optical mouse, etc. If you want a better graphics card, opt for a 9800 Pro XT, 5900 or 5950—which will cost about Rs 35,000.

8X on 4X

Q. I have an Intel D845GBV motherboard with Intel Extreme Graphics and a 4X AGP slot with the 1.5 V specification. Will an 8X AGP card fit and work properly in my 4X AGP slot? I want to buy the latest GeForce FX series card. Can you suggest which one?

My 40 GB hard disk is split into four partitions, with C allocated 11 GB, while D, E and F have 9 GB each. Earlier, I had Windows Me on the C drive and Windows XP on D. The D drive is in NTFS format, and I have now loaded Windows 98 on C. How do I access my D drive when working in windows 98? I have the Windows XP Pro CD.

Jimmy Varghese

A Yes, you can use an AGP 8X card in an AGP 4X slot. AGP 8X supports 1.5 volts, but you won't be able to experience the full power of the card. The GeForce FX from Compro is a good choice in the GeForce series, and has won the Digit Best Value award in 2003.